

KID CITY

VOLUNTEER GUIDEBOOK

Your guide to serving in Kid City at **City Church Lufkin**

LOVE GOD | LOVE OTHERS | BE YOU | HAVE FUN

SECTION 01

01

WELCOME TO THE TEAM

You belong here.



KID CITY · WELCOME

A LETTER TO OUR TEAM

To our incredible Kid City Serve Team,

What you do matters more than you know.

Every Sunday, families walk through our doors hoping — maybe even praying — that their children will be safe, loved, and pointed toward Jesus. You are the answer to that hope. You are not just filling a slot on a schedule. You are a minister. You are a pastor to children. You are a partner to parents who are trusting us with their most precious people.

Kid City exists because we believe kids deserve a church experience that is entirely their own — a place where they are seen, known, and celebrated. Everything we do flows from four values:

LOVE GOD · LOVE OTHERS · BE YOU · HAVE FUN

This guidebook will show you the what and the how — but never lose sight of the why: because every child in Kid City is deeply loved by God, and you get to show them that.

WELCOME TO THE TEAM.

This is where you **BELONG**.

Eric & Christy Barton

Lead Pastors, City Church Lufkin

SECTION 02

02

MISSION & VALUES

Why we do what we do.



SECTION 02 · MISSION

OUR MISSION

WE EXIST TO...

See people lead full lives in Christ. — John 10:10

Kid City exists to partner with parents in leading their children to become fully engaged followers of Jesus. Through fun worship, engaging environments, and consistent leaders, children are exposed to God's Word and challenged to apply it as they develop an authentic faith.

KID CITY OBJECTIVE

Grow and develop kids so that in God's timing, they will be raised up into the full life found only in Jesus Christ!



SECTION 02 · KID CITY VALUES

OUR VALUES

LOVE GOD

We love God first — and we model that love openly for kids. When we worship with energy, pray over children, and teach the Word with passion, we show kids what a life devoted to God looks like. Every Sunday is an act of worship.

LOVE OTHERS

We love people on purpose. We know names. We remember details. We greet families like they're family. From the first hello at Check-In to the goodbye at pick-up, every interaction is an opportunity to make someone feel loved and valued.

BE YOU

We celebrate kids for exactly who they are — wiggly, creative, loud, quiet, curious, and wonderful. We create safety where kids don't have to perform to belong. And as a volunteer, you bring your unique gifts to this team. Be you.

HAVE FUN

Fun is not a distraction from ministry — it IS ministry. Kids come back to places where they have fun. Laughter, games, energy, and joy are tools of the Kingdom. If the kids are having a great time, we're doing it right.

HOW WE KEEP KID CITY SAFE

Kid City is committed to providing a safe, age-appropriate environment for every child. These are commitments we make — not values, but non-negotiables:

- Two-adult rule — adults are never alone with a child. At least two adults are present in every room at all times.
- Background checks — every volunteer is background-checked before serving in any Kid City environment.
- Secure check-in — every child is checked in and out by a registered guardian. No exceptions.
- Age-appropriate content — every lesson, activity, and environment is designed with developmental stages in mind. We're not here to entertain or babysit — we're here to help kids understand Jesus at their level.

WHAT WINNING LOOKS LIKE

In Kid City, we measure wins in moments — not metrics.

- A child who walks in nervous and leaves with a smile.
- A parent who trusts us enough to walk away and actually experience church.
- A baby who was prayed over, changed, and held while mom worshipped.
- A 5-year-old who heard about Jesus for the very first time.
- A family who felt at home from the moment they walked in.
- A room full of kids who can't wait to come back next Sunday.

Every role in Kid City exists to create those moments. **Touch someone's heart today.**

**SECTION 02 · CITY CHURCH**

OUR CHURCH CULTURE

Kid City doesn't exist in isolation — we are part of City Church Lufkin. The same values that drive our entire church family also drive what we do with children every single week.

MISSION PILLARS

City Church exists to see people lead full lives in Christ. We define that full life in four pillars — and Kid City is often where people first experience all four.

HOPE

There is meaning, purpose, and a future — and it is found in Jesus.

COMMUNITY

We become who God called us to be in real relationships with others.

PURPOSE

Your life matters. We help you discover who you are in Christ.

IMPACT

We live bigger than ourselves by serving and making a difference.

CHURCH VALUES

These are the core values of City Church — they shape every ministry, every team, and every Sunday in Kid City.

LOVE IS OUR MOTIVE

Everything we do flows from love — love for God and love for people. — 1 Cor 16:14

GOD'S PRESENCE IS OUR PASSION

We don't just attend church — we passionately pursue the presence of God. — Psalm 16:11

JOY IS OUR EXPRESSION

We carry the joy of the Lord into everything we do. — Nehemiah 8:10

COMMUNITY IS OUR COMMITMENT

We grow, serve, and thrive through real relationships with one another. — 1 Cor 12:27

SERVING IS OUR PRIVILEGE

We follow Jesus' example by serving with humility and love. We don't have to — we get to. — Mark 10:45

EXCELLENCE IS OUR WORSHIP

We give our best in every detail — not for perfection's sake, but as an act of honor and worship to God. — Colossians 3:23

GENEROSITY IS OUR WAY

We live open-handed with our time, resources, and hearts. — 2 Cor 9:11



SECTION 02 · TEAM VALUES

TEAM VALUES

These values describe who we are as a team — how we treat each other, lead ourselves, and show up every week.

I AM A SERVANT LEADER

I lead by serving. I look for ways to make the team and the people around me better.

I CHOOSE TO SEE THE BEST

I believe the best about my team, my leaders, and the families we serve. Cynicism has no place here.

I AM COMMITTED TO GROWTH

I am not done. I stay hungry to learn, improve, and develop as a leader and as a person.

I TAKE OWNERSHIP

I don't wait to be told. I see what needs to be done and I do it — with excellence and a good attitude.

I WILL COMMUNICATE

I keep the team informed. I don't go dark. I speak up early when something isn't working.

I HELP OTHERS TAKE STEPS

My job isn't just to do my role — it's to help the people around me grow and move forward.

SECTION 03

03

TEAM OVERVIEW

Every role matters. Every person matters.



SECTION 03 · ENVIRONMENTS

OUR ROOMS

ROOM	AGES	DESCRIPTION
Kid City	Ages 5–11 (up to 5th grade)	Elementary service: worship, Bible teaching & media
Mini City	Ages 4 & under	Early childhood wing — all rooms below
Baby Blvd	3 months – 18 months	Nursery care for our youngest babies
Toddler Trail	18 months – 3 years	Active toddler room with play & Bible teaching
Preschool Place	Ages 3–4	Pre-K room: teaching, worship, crafts & activities
Check-In	All families	First touchpoint for every family

GENERAL EXPECTATIONS

These expectations apply to every Kid City team member, every role, every week.

- Arrive 30 minutes before service — your room needs you before the first family walks in.
- Manage your schedule through Planning Center and communicate promptly with your team lead.
- Pray for the families and children you will serve before every Sunday.
- Attend the pre-service Serve Team Huddle every week.
- Wash your hands upon arrival and throughout service as needed.
- Wear your volunteer badge at all times during service.
- If you cannot serve on a scheduled day, communicate as early as possible through Planning Center or GroupMe.
- Alert your team lead immediately of any safety concerns, allergies, or security issues.
- Carry the Kid City Values into everything you do: Love God · Love Others · Be You · Have Fun.

SECTION 04

04

ROLE DESCRIPTIONS

Every role. Every team. Every person.



SECTION 04 · LEADERSHIP

KID CITY DIRECTOR

KID CITY DIRECTOR Paid Staff

REPORTS TO *Lead Pastors*

The Kid City Director oversees all children's ministry at City Church — from birth through 5th grade. They build safe, fun, and spiritually transformative environments where kids encounter Jesus, grow in their faith, and make church their favorite place to be.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Lead, develop, and shepherd all Kid City volunteers and team leads across every age group (birth–5th grade).
- Create and maintain engaging, age-appropriate ministry environments that reflect City Church's culture and values.
- Implement safe environment policies and ensure all volunteers are trained, background-checked, and equipped.
- Develop systems for check-in, classroom management, parent communication, and volunteer scheduling.
- Collaborate with Lead Pastors to align Kid City with the church's overall vision and Next Steps pathway.

THE WIN *Kids show up excited, parents drop off their children with full confidence, and volunteers feel valued and equipped. Kid City is a front door for families in Lufkin.*

SECTION 04 · CHECK-IN

KIDS CHECK-IN

The Check-In team is the very first impression every family has of Kid City. Your warmth and competence communicate to parents: "Your child is going to be great here."

KIDS CHECK-IN Volunteer

REPORTS TO *Kid City Director*

The Kids Check-In team is the first point of contact for families in Kid City — welcoming parents and children with warmth and checking every child in safely and efficiently.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Arrive early and have the check-in system ready before families arrive.
- Check in every child accurately, print labels, and ensure parents receive security

tags.

- Welcome families warmly and help new families navigate Kid City with ease and confidence.
- Greet every parent and child by name — be intentional about learning and remembering them.
- Note and communicate any allergies, care instructions, or security concerns to room leaders.
- Only allow adults with a Parent Pick-Up tag into the Kids wing after check-in closes.

THE WIN *Every family gets checked in quickly and correctly. Parents feel safe leaving their kids, and children leave the check-in table excited to go to class.*



SECTION 04 · ELEMENTARY

KID CITY — AGES 5-11

Our elementary service for kids ages 5–11. High-energy worship, Bible teaching, games, and activities designed to bring God's Word alive.

KID CITY TEACHER — ELEMENTARY Volunteer

REPORTS TO *Kid City Director*

Kid City Teachers lead elementary-aged children through age-appropriate lessons, helping them discover who Jesus is and how to live for Him.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Prepare and teach the weekly lesson with energy, creativity, and clarity.
- Create a safe, fun, and engaging classroom environment where every child feels seen.
- Lead worship with energy and authenticity — model what genuine worship looks like.
- Know your kids by name and build relationships week to week.
- Manage the room: keep it safe, focused, and fun.
- Pray for and invest in the children in your class beyond Sunday morning.

THE WIN *Kids leave class knowing what they learned, having had fun, and feeling genuinely known by their teacher. Over time, the Word is taking root.*

KID CITY MEDIA HELPER — ELEMENTARY Volunteer

REPORTS TO *Kid City Teacher*

The Media Helper supports the elementary classroom by running ProPresenter slides, videos, and media elements that support the lesson.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Run slides, videos, and media in sync with the teacher and lesson flow throughout class.
- Keep the tech running smoothly so the teacher can focus entirely on the kids.
- Review the lesson content before class so you can anticipate what's coming.
- Arrive early and test all A/V equipment before service.

THE WIN *The teacher never has to worry about tech. Every video plays, every slide is on cue, and class flows without interruption.*

KID CITY HELPER — ELEMENTARY Volunteer

REPORTS TO *Kid City Teacher*

Helpers assist the teacher in managing the classroom, engaging kids, and ensuring a safe, fun, and welcoming environment.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Assist the teacher with classroom management, activities, and small group moments.
- Build relationships with the kids in your class — learn their names and their stories.
- Help maintain a safe, orderly environment where every child feels welcome.
- Assist with parent pick-up at dismissal — verify Parent Pick-Up tags.

THE WIN *The teacher feels fully supported, kids are engaged and safe, and helpers are building real relationships with the next generation.*



SECTION 04 · MINI CITY

MINI CITY — BIRTH TO 4

Mini City is our early childhood wing for children from birth through 4 years old, including Baby Blvd (nursery), Toddler Trail, and Preschool Place.

MINI CITY COORDINATOR — BIRTH TO 4 YEARS Volunteer

REPORTS TO *Kid City Director*

The Mini City Coordinator oversees all rooms serving children from birth through 4 years — Nursery, Toddlers, and Pre-School — ensuring every environment is safe, nurturing, and age-appropriate.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Coordinate volunteers across the Nursery, Toddlers, and Pre-School rooms each Sunday.
- Ensure all rooms are clean, stocked, and ready before families begin arriving.
- Communicate with parents about their child's experience and address any needs during the service.

THE WIN *Parents trust City Church with their youngest children. Every baby and toddler is well-cared-for, content, and safe.*

ROOM LEADER — NURSERY / TODDLERS / PRE-SCHOOL Volunteer

REPORTS TO *Mini City Coordinator*

Room Leaders oversee their specific age room, leading helpers and ensuring every child is safe, engaged, and well cared for.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Lead the helpers in your room and ensure adequate coverage for the children present.
- Create a nurturing, age-appropriate environment where every child feels comfortable and safe.
- Communicate any needs, incidents, or concerns to the Mini City Coordinator.

THE WIN *Every child in your room is safe, happy, and engaged. Parents pick up their children to big smiles and a positive report.*

TEACHER & HELPER — NURSERY / TODDLERS / PRE-

SCHOOL Volunteer

REPORTS TO *Room Leader*

Teachers and Helpers in Mini City serve the youngest members of City Church with love, patience, and intentional care.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Care for the children in your room with warmth, attentiveness, and a genuine servant heart.
- Follow all safe environment policies, including check-in/check-out procedures at all times.
- Assist the Room Leader with activities, diaper changes, and all general care needs.

THE WIN *Every child is cared for as if they were your own. Parents come back every week because they trust their children are safe and deeply loved.*

SECTION 05

05

POLICIES & PROCEDURES

How we keep kids safe and families confident.

**SECTION 05 · REQUIREMENTS**

VOLUNTEER REQUIREMENTS

To serve with children at City Church, every volunteer must complete the following steps:

READ THE GUIDEBOOK

Specifically the sections that pertain to your area of service.

THREE MONTH RULE

You must have been involved with City Church for at least three (3) months before serving with children.

FILL OUT AN APPLICATION

Supplied by us. All info is kept confidential on file at the City Church offices.

BACKGROUND CHECK

Required to work with minors at any level. Results are maintained in confidence at the City Church Lufkin offices.

PERSONAL INTERVIEW

A face-to-face interview with the team leader to discuss serving desires, capacity, and giftings.

REFERENCE CHECKS

We will verify references listed on the application prior to approval.

COMPLETE TRAINING

Complete any necessary training for your position.

OBTAIN VOLUNTEER BADGE

Report to Volunteer Check-In before serving.

STUDENT VOLUNTEERS

Middle school and high school students (age 14+) may volunteer in Kid City under the supervision of staff or adult volunteers.

- Check in with the Lead Volunteer at least 30 minutes before the service begins.
- Follow the direction of the Lead Volunteer and other adult volunteers at all times.
- Stay in the classroom until the service is over and most children have been checked out.

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- No electronic devices are allowed in use during service.
 - You must attend the service during the time you are not volunteering.
 - Parent must understand and clear the student to volunteer in Kid City.
 - Students must be at least age 14 and never left alone with minors.



SECTION 05 · CHECK-IN

CHECK-IN PROCEDURES

We use Planning Center Check-Ins on iPads at the check-in station. Follow these steps every Sunday:

#	STEP	WHAT TO DO
01	Open the App	Turn on the iPad and open Planning Center Check-Ins. Connect to Wi-Fi (C1tyChurchH). The correct event should already be selected.
02	Returning Family	Parent types their phone number, selects children checking in, and badges print automatically from the assigned Brother printer.
03	First-Time Family	If no profile exists, direct to the First-Time Visitor Podium or QR code. Complete their registration and check them in.
04	Badges Print	Each child gets a name badge. Mini City children get 2 badges (child + bag). A parent pick-up tag prints — the parent MUST have this for pick-up.
05	New Family Guest Cards	Place the parent pick-up sticker on the back of the Guest Card. Encourage them to fill it out and turn it in at end of service.
06	Allergy / Security Flags	Food/environmental allergy → YELLOW sticker on badge. Security concern → notify Safety Team + RED sticker on child's badge and parent tag.
07	Check-In Closes	~20 minutes after service starts. Only adults with a Parent Pick-Up tag may enter the Kids wing after this point.

SETUP INFO

3 iPads — each paired ONLY to its assigned Brother printer

1 Mac computer with Bluetooth printer

- Mac login: citychurch | Wi-Fi password: C1tyChurchH
- Troubleshooting guide is located at the check-in station. Restart the device first if anything isn't working — then contact your team lead.

CHECKING OUT CHILDREN

- Children are NOT to be released to anyone other than the adult with the correct security tag.
- Siblings are NOT allowed to pick up younger brothers and sisters, even with the security tag.
- Verify that the number on the parent's sticker matches the child's sticker on the way out.

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- If a parent cannot present their security tag, contact the Team Leader immediately.
 - If a parent loses their sticker, they wait until all others are picked up, then show ID to the Lead Volunteer.

**SECTION 05 · SAFETY**

SECURITY & SAFETY

TWO ADULT RULE

A minimum of two unrelated adult workers will be with children at all times. If there is ever only one worker in a classroom, doors should remain open and there should be no fewer than 3 kids present. We do not allow minors to be alone with one adult on our premises or in any sponsored activity.

SECURITY MEASURES

- Volunteers match the sticker number of the child to the parent's number — every time a parent enters or exits with a child.
- Only volunteers with appropriate ID, parents with correct documentation, or staff with name badges are allowed past the security checkpoint.
- No adult may work in an environment without a completed application and background check.
- Every classroom will have two adults present at all times. NO adult is ever alone with a child.

EVACUATION PROCEDURE

In the event of an emergency requiring evacuation, the Lead Volunteer is the point person. Gather children into groups. Infants go in cribs/strollers. Toddlers are walked or carried outside. Follow exit signs to the closest door. Upon exiting, account for all children.

HOW TO PAGE A PARENT

Page a parent if a child has been crying for 10+ minutes, is overly disruptive, or complains of illness.

- Go to the Volunteer Leader and give them the child's name and sticker number.
- The Leader notifies the Production Director via Planning Center Live — a message appears on the screen in the adult service.
- Parents come to the Check-In Station and are escorted to the classroom.

**SECTION 05 · HEALTH**

WELLNESS & HEALTH

To ensure the health of children and volunteers, we ask that sick children do not attend Kid City. A child should not attend if any of the following symptoms are present:

- Fever over 100.4°F
- Vomiting or diarrhea within the last 24 hours
- Any symptom of childhood diseases such as scarlet fever, measles, mumps, chicken pox, or whooping cough
- Common cold, including colored runny nose or sore throat
- Croup, unexplained rash, or any skin infection (boils, ringworm, impetigo)
- Untreated pink eye or other eye infection
- Any communicable disease
- Lice, including the presence of eggs or nits

A child or volunteer must be fever-free for 24 hours before returning to Kid City.

MEDICATION POLICY

Kid City volunteers WILL NOT administer any medication except in life-threatening situations. Medications should be administered by a parent at home or before drop-off. If a child has a life-threatening condition, a Medication Authorization Form must be completed and signed by the parent.

ACCIDENTS & EMERGENCIES

Life-threatening situation (loss of consciousness, significant blood loss, difficulty breathing): call 911 immediately, then notify the Leader. Minor accidents: treat using the first-aid kit and fill out an Incident Report. The witness of any accident must complete an Incident Report before leaving.

**SECTION 05 · CHILD INTERACTION**

WORKING WITH CHILDREN

CHILDREN WITH SPECIAL NEEDS

Special needs children are part of the whole — not separated from the group. Every child is included in all activities. A child who needs extra assistance will be matched with a volunteer to work one-on-one within the classroom.

DISCIPLINE GUIDELINES

- Use a firm but gentle voice to address problem behaviors.
- Focus your remarks on the behavior you want to see — not the child.
- Never use sarcasm, shaming, or a tone that frightens a child.
- Never make negative remarks about appearance, race, or gender.
- Never use corporal punishment or spanking of any kind.
- Appropriate touch: high fives, pat on back/shoulders. Inappropriate: demanding hugs, kissing.
- If a child will not respond, notify the team leader who will page the parents.

REPORTING POTENTIAL ABUSE

Kid City is required by law to report suspected abuse of a child. The staff person over the environment is a Mandated Reporter to the Department of Family and Child Services.

- Report any suspicions of child abuse or neglect to the Lead Volunteer or Staff person immediately.
- Do not wait or second-guess your observations.
- All allegations of abuse must be reported to Civil authorities (done by the team lead).

**SECTION 05 · NURSERY POLICIES**

EARLY CHILDHOOD CARE

DIAPERING

Check diapers of all infants and toddlers during each service. If a child attends more than one service, check each time.

- Diapering must be performed at diaper stations within eyesight of other care providers.
- Cover changing pad with wax paper. Have all supplies ready before placing child on the table.
- Wear surgical gloves. Keep one hand on the child at all times.
- Seal dirty diapers in plastic bags, throw away wax paper and gloves.
- All babies must be changed before end of service.
- Student volunteers are not to change diapers.

CRYING CHILDREN

Tend to immediate needs: diaper change, hunger, or engagement in an activity. Quiet reading, music, or art often soothes crying children.

IMPORTANT

If a child has been crying consistently for 10 minutes, it is time to page the parent. Notify the Volunteer Leader immediately.

BATHROOM POLICIES

- A same-gender adult should walk the child to the bathroom. The Two Adult Rule applies.
- If the child needs help, keep the door open and assist them — maintaining the Two Adult Rule.
- Always wash your hands and the child's hands after bathroom use.
- Check the bathroom is clear of other adults before a child enters.

FEEDING

- Follow the parent's instructions in detail when feeding children.
- Bottle and food must be administered by adult volunteers only — not student helpers.
- Ensure bottle or food is properly labeled. Check for allergies before beginning.
- Burp infants after giving them a bottle.



SECTION 05 · PRO-KID POLICY

PRO-KID POLICY

A core value at Kid City is to create contagious environments. The main service is designed for adults. Kid City environments are designed specifically with kids in mind — so every child learns according to their developmental age.

OUR POLICY

Children over three months old are encouraged to be in their class — not in the adult worship service.

Three reasons for this policy:

CONTENT

The adult service talks about topics not always appropriate for children. We don't want anything to promote the idea that God is boring, church is irrelevant, or Jesus is not for them.

DISTRACTIONS

We want every adult in the room to fully engage in worship and the message, without the distraction of managing a young child.

APPROPRIATE ENVIRONMENTS

We have excellent, age-appropriate environments for children. Teaching them in ways they can understand is keeping with the spirit of Jesus and the importance He placed on children.

The Pro-Kid Policy is not a rule against children being in an adult service — it is a policy that values the importance of kids knowing Jesus as their friend.

SECTION 06

06

FORMS

Keep these on hand — every week.



SECTION 06 · FORMS

INCIDENT REPORT

The witness of any accident must complete this form before leaving for the day. Be honest with parents and do not offer medical advice.

Child's Name:	Parent's Name(s):
Supervising Adults:	
Date:	Time:
Location:	
Parents Notified By:	Time:
Describe the Incident:	
Describe the Extent of the Injury:	
Describe the First Aid and Course of Treatment:	
Signature (Person Completing Report):	Date:
Signature of Leader:	Date:



SECTION 06 · FORMS

LOST NAME TAG FORM

Child's Full Name:

Parent's Full Name:

Address:

City:

State:

Zip:

Home Phone:

Cell Phone:

Driver's License Number:

State:

ID Checked by:

MEDICAL AUTHORIZATION FORM

Child's Full Name:

Parent's Full Name:

Address:

City:

State:

Zip:

Home Phone:

Cell Phone:

Instructions:

I authorize a Kid City adult volunteer to administer medication in case of emergency as described above.

Parent's Signature:

Date:

REMEMBER THE PURPOSE

**YOU'RE NOT JUST
WATCHING BABIES.
YOU'RE CHANGING
ETERNITY.**

What a difference you are making!!

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